

DESCRIPTION OF PROJECT

512 WASHINGTON STREET

Essex County Habitat for Humanity (the "Applicant") is a nonprofit organization that helps families build and improve places to call home. They believe affordable housing plays a critical role in strong and stable communities and that everyone deserves a decent place to live. Unfortunately, 1 in 4 families pay 50% or more of their income on housing and therefore cannot contribute to the community or build a future. With affordable homeownership, families are able to achieve the strength, stability, and independence they need to build a better life for themselves and for their families.

The Applicant is requesting a Special Permit from the City Council so that they may continue their mission at 512 Washington Street by renovating the existing house on the property and dividing it into three (3) affordable housing units. The existing dilapidated garage on the property will be torn down. The Applicant then proposes to build a duplex on either side of the existing house, adding an additional four (4) affordable housing units to the property. Once complete, the entire property consisting of a total of seven (7) residential units will be converted to condominiums. There will be a provision within the condominium documents, as well as restrictions in each of the deeds, stating that every unit shall perpetually be defined as affordable housing. Each unit will then be sold to qualified low-income home buyers.